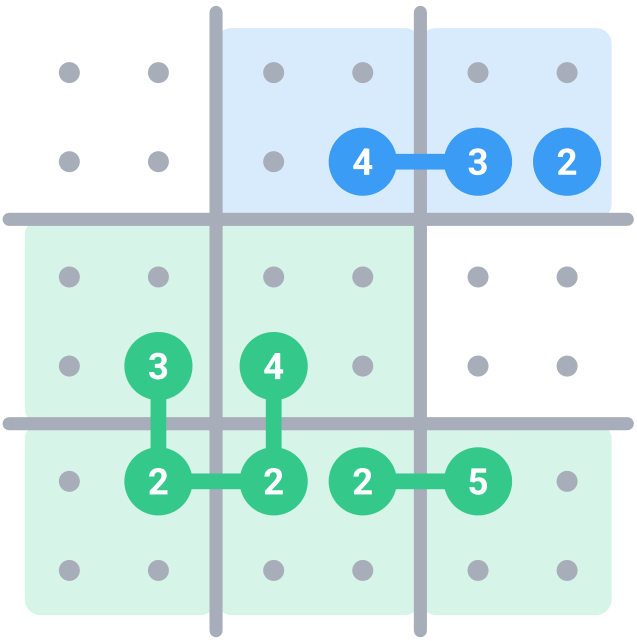
Province

A strategy game of bridges and borders

How to play | 2 players | 6×6 and 8×8 boards | free, in your browser



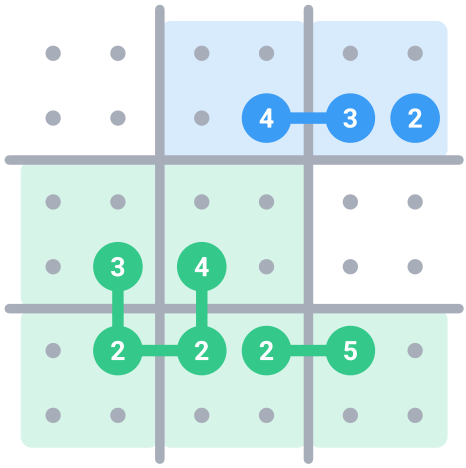
province-game.com

1 The goal

Be the first to control **5 connected provinces** (**8** on the big board).

Rivers split the board into **provinces**, blocks of 2×2 squares (9 provinces on the 6×6 board, 16 on the 8×8 board). You **control** a province when **only you** have soldiers in it. If both colours are inside, nobody controls it.

The provinces you control must be **connected**: the only way across a river is a bridge, so your provinces are joined by **your bridges**. Loose provinces do not count.



Green controls the 5 shaded provinces on the left and bottom, joined by green bridges: that is a win.

Blue holds only a few provinces in the top corner.

The win is checked at the **end of every turn**. Whoever has the connected provinces at the end of their turn wins.

2 What you have

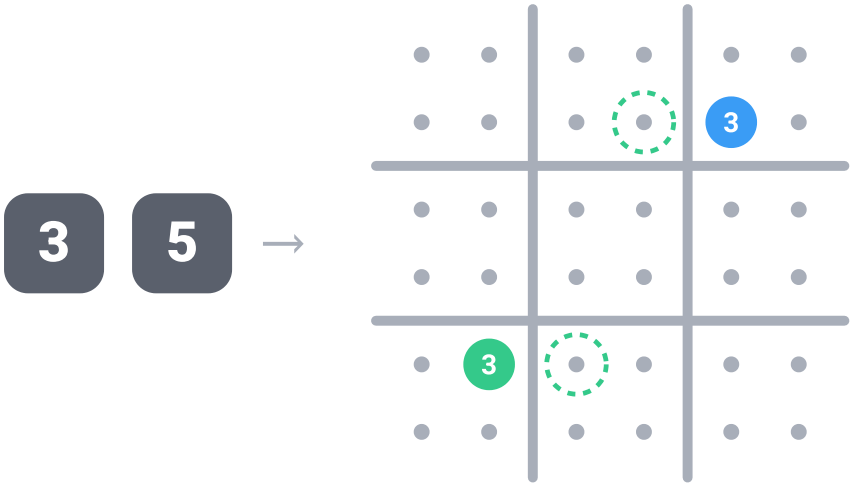
	6×6 BOARD	8×8 BOARD
Provinces	9	16
Soldiers each	36	54
Bridges each	8	14
Dice	1 to 6	1 to 8
To win	5 connected provinces	8 connected provinces

Soldiers that are not on the board wait in your **camp**. Soldiers that die are gone for good (the **graveyard**).

Bridges are limited. You get a fixed number for the **whole game**, and every bridge you build is gone for good. The counter next to the arch icon shows how many you have left.

3 Your turn

1. **Roll the dice.** The two numbers light up **two squares**, on opposite sides of the board.
2. **Re-roll if you want.** Once per turn you may throw the dice again. The new roll **replaces** the old one, so you cannot go back to the first squares.
3. **Make one move** on a lit square (see section 4).
4. The turn passes to your opponent.



The numbers on the dice point to **two squares**, one on each side of the board. You pick one of them.

No legal move? If the lit squares give you nothing to do, tap **Re-roll**. If the new roll gives nothing either, you tap **Pass** and the turn goes to your opponent. Pass only appears after you have used your re-roll.

4 What a lit square lets you do

Land
New soldiers from your camp come down on a lit square that is empty or already yours. They land **only on the lit square**, never in enemy territory.

Move
Take any number of soldiers from a base to a square next to it. Moving across a river builds a bridge (see section 5).

Attack
Move onto a square held by the enemy. Each attacker kills one defender (see below).

Withdraw
Pull soldiers from a base back to your camp.

Transport
Send soldiers from a base in a **straight line** through your own territory to another of your bases, in one go.

Build a bridge
Place a bridge across a river. You can also move soldiers over it in the same move: building a bridge and moving is **one turn**, not two.

Which squares can you use?

- A lit square **inside your territory** lets you play from **any** of your bases there: it does not have to be the base you move from.
- A lit square that is **next to one of your bases** lets you move or attack onto it from that base.
- A lit square deep in enemy territory with none of your bases next to it: you cannot use it.

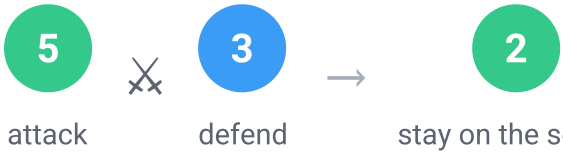
Territory

Your **territory** is the connected area made of your bases and your controlled provinces (even their empty squares), joined by your bridges. The bigger it is, the more lit squares you can use.

5 Attacks, rivers and bridges

Attack

- Each attacking soldier kills **one** defender.
- The defenders that die are **gone for good**.
- The attackers that did the killing are **worn out**: they leave the board and go back to your camp to rest.
- Extra attackers (more than defenders) **stay** on the captured square. Equal numbers leave the square empty.

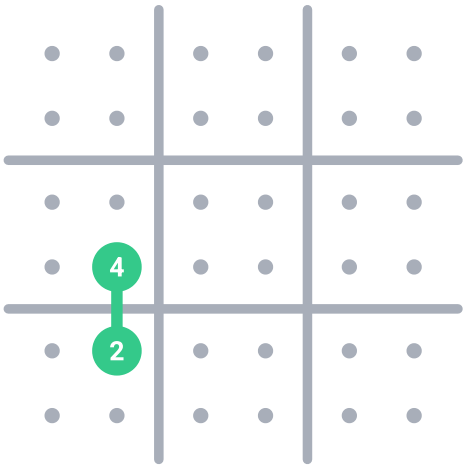


3 worn-out attackers **go back to camp**.
3 defenders are **dead for good**.

Example: 5 attackers against 3 defenders. Equal numbers would leave the square empty.

Rivers and bridges

- You can only cross a river on a **bridge**. Moving across a river with no bridge **builds yours**, as part of the move.
- A bridge belongs to the player who built it. Only they can cross it.
- You **can replace an enemy bridge** with yours if you hold the squares at **both ends**.



Moving from the top square to the one below crosses a river, so the move **builds a bridge** and uses one of your limited bridges.
